

Tab 1

Team Onboarding Guide: Local Setup & Feature Development

Welcome to the **Research AI Platform** project! Follow these steps in order to get the project running on your machine and start building your assigned features.

Phase 1: Machine Prerequisites

Make sure you have the following installed on your computer before starting:

1. **Python 3.13.x** — [Download Python 3.13](#) (⚠️ Check "Add python.exe to PATH" during installation!)
2. **Git** — [Download Git](#)
3. **PostgreSQL 16 or 17** — [Download PostgreSQL](#) (Remember the superuser password you set during installation)

Phase 2: Clone & Environment Setup

Open **PowerShell** in the directory where you want your project folder to live, and run:

1. Clone the GitHub Repository

```
PowerShell
git clone https://github.com/rafitboo/ai-research-assistant.git
cd ai-research-assistant
```

2. Create & Activate Virtual Environment

```
PowerShell
python -m venv venv // ei line e py -3.13 -m venv venv
.\venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

(You should now see `(venv)` at the left of your terminal prompt).

3. Install Required Dependencies

```
PowerShell
pip install -r requirements.txt
pip install email-validator --upgrade
```

```
pip install sqlalchemy --upgrade
```

Phase 3: Local PostgreSQL Database Setup

1. Create User and Database

Open the app→ **SQL Shell (psql)** from your Windows Start Menu (press Enter for defaults and enter your root PostgreSQL password when prompted), then execute these SQL commands:

SQL

```
CREATE USER research_user WITH PASSWORD '471';  
CREATE DATABASE research_db OWNER research_user;  
GRANT ALL PRIVILEGES ON DATABASE research_db TO research_user;
```

2. Create the **.env** File

In the project root, navigate into the **backend** directory and create a new file named **.env**:

File Path: **ai-research-assistant/backend/.env**

Code snippet

```
DB_USER=research_user  
DB_PASSWORD=my_secure_password  
DB_HOST=127.0.0.1  
DB_PORT=5432  
DB_NAME=research_db  
DATABASE_URL=postgresql://research_user:my_secure_password@127.0.0.1:5432/research_db
```

Phase 4: Run the Application Locally

You will need **two terminal windows** running simultaneously:

Terminal 1: FastAPI Backend

PowerShell

```
# Make sure (venv) is active  
cd backend  
uvicorn main:app --reload --port 8000
```

Note: On first startup, SQLAlchemy will automatically detect your local PostgreSQL database and generate all necessary tables (`users`, `papers`, `projects`, `project_members`).

Terminal 2: Flask Frontend

Open a new PowerShell window in the project root directory:

```
PowerShell  
.\venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1  
python frontend/app.py
```

Open your browser and visit [\[http://127.0.0.1:5000\]](http://127.0.0.1:5000)(<http://127.0.0.1:5000>). You can now register a new account and test the **Dashboard Overview**!

Tab 2

Git Collaboration Protocol

To avoid overwriting each other's work while developing:

1. Pull Latest Changes Before Starting

PowerShell
git checkout main
git pull origin main

2. Create a Feature Branch

PowerShell
For Feature 2:
git checkout -b feature-2-paper-library

For Feature 3:
git checkout -b feature-3-progress-tracker

For Feature 4:
git checkout -b feature-4-project-creation

3. Commit & Push Your Feature

Once your assigned feature is complete and tested locally:

PowerShell
git add .
git commit -m "Completed Module 1 - Feature X: <Feature Name>"
git push origin feature-X-branch-name

Then open GitHub to merge your feature branch into **main**!

Tab 3

DB:

PUSH:

```
$env:Path += ";C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\17\bin"
```

```
& "C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\17\bin\pg_dump.exe" -U research_user -h 127.0.0.1 -p 5432  
-F c -f "$HOME\research_db.backup" research_db
```

IF DB NOT CREATED:

- Open **SQL Shell (psql)** from the Windows Start Menu.
 -
 - Press **Enter** for these defaults:
 -
 - Server [localhost]:
 - Database [postgres]:
 - Port [5432]:
 - Username [postgres]:
 -
 - Enter your PostgreSQL administrator password. **471**
 -
 - **You should see:**
 - **postgres=#**
- CREATE DATABASE research_db OWNER research_user;
- Run this in PowerShell:
 - & "C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\17\bin\pg_restore.exe" -h 127.0.0.1 -U research_user -d research_db --no-owner --no-privileges "C:\Users\user\Downloads\research_db.backup"
-
- Enter the password: **471**
- Run this command:

& "C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\17\bin\psql.exe" -h 127.0.0.1 -U research_user -d research_db\

 - Enter 471
 - Then run \dt
 - You should see tables such as: users, papers, projects, project_members
 - To inspect the data: SELECT * FROM users;
 - Exit with \q

IF DB CREATED:

- Open **SQL Shell (psql)** from the Windows Start Menu.
 - Press **Enter** for these defaults:
 - Server [localhost]:
 - Database [postgres]:
 - Port [5432]:
 - Username [postgres]:
 - Enter your PostgreSQL administrator password. **471**
 - **You should see:**
 - **postgres=#**
- Run these commands one at a time:
 - `SELECT pg_terminate_backend(pid)`
 - `FROM pg_stat_activity`
 - `WHERE datname = 'research_db'`
 - `AND pid <> pg_backend_pid();`
- `DROP DATABASE research_db;`
- `CREATE DATABASE research_db OWNER research_user;`
- Run this in PowerShell:
 - & "C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\17\bin\pg_restore.exe" -h 127.0.0.1 -U research_user -d research_db --no-owner --no-privileges "C:\Users\user\Downloads\research_db.backup"
-
- Enter the password: **471**
- Run this command:
 - & "C:\Program Files\PostgreSQL\17\bin\psql.exe" -h 127.0.0.1 -U research_user -d research_db\
- Enter 471
- Then run \dt

- You should see tables such as:users, papers, projects, project_members
- To inspect the data: `SELECT * FROM users;`
- Exit with `\q`

module-1 feature-2

Here is the complete implementation for **Module 1 — Feature 2: Paper Upload & Library**. Before starting, make sure you have `python-multipart` installed in your virtual environment (required by FastAPI to process PDF file uploads and form inputs):

PowerShell

```
pip install python-multipart
```



File 1: Create Backend Router (New File)

Create a brand new file at `backend/app/routers/papers.py`.

Python

```
import os
import uuid
from typing import Optional
from fastapi import APIRouter, Depends, HTTPException, UploadFile, File, Form, Query
from fastapi.responses import FileResponse
from sqlalchemy.orm import Session
from app.database import get_db
from app.models import Paper, User
from app.auth_utils import get_current_user

router = APIRouter(prefix="/api/papers", tags=["Papers"])

# Upload directory path inside backend folder
UPLOAD_DIR = os.path.join(os.path.dirname(os.path.dirname(os.path.dirname(__file__))),
"uploads")
os.makedirs(UPLOAD_DIR, exist_ok=True)

@router.post("/upload")
def upload_paper(
    title: str = Form(...),
    author: Optional[str] = Form(None),
    year: Optional[int] = Form(None),
    topic: Optional[str] = Form(None),
    research_area: Optional[str] = Form(None),
    tags: Optional[str] = Form(None),
    file: Optional[UploadFile] = File(None),
    current_user: dict = Depends(get_current_user),
    db: Session = Depends(get_db)
):
    user_id = current_user["user_id"]

    saved_file_path = None
    if file and file.filename:
        # Generate unique filename to prevent overwriting
        file_ext = os.path.splitext(file.filename)[1]
```

```

unique_filename = f"{uuid.uuid4().hex}{file_ext}"
saved_file_path = os.path.join(UPLOAD_DIR, unique_filename)

with open(saved_file_path, "wb") as buffer:
    buffer.write(file.read())

new_paper = Paper(
    title=title,
    author=author,
    year=year,
    topic=topic,
    research_area=research_area,
    tags=tags,
    file_path=saved_file_path,
    reading_status="Unread",
    read_percentage=0,
    time_spent_seconds=0,
    user_id=user_id
)
db.add(new_paper)
db.commit()
db.refresh(new_paper)

return {"message": "Paper uploaded successfully", "paper_id": new_paper.id}

```

```

@router.get("/")
def list_papers(
    topic: Optional[str] = Query(None),
    year: Optional[int] = Query(None),
    author: Optional[str] = Query(None),
    research_area: Optional[str] = Query(None),
    search: Optional[str] = Query(None),
    current_user: dict = Depends(get_current_user),
    db: Session = Depends(get_db)
):
    user_id = current_user["user_id"]
    query = db.query(Paper).filter(Paper.user_id == user_id)

    # Filtering logic
    if topic and topic.strip():
        query = query.filter(Paper.topic.ilike(f"%{topic.strip()}%"))
    if year:
        query = query.filter(Paper.year == year)
    if author and author.strip():
        query = query.filter(Paper.author.ilike(f"%{author.strip()}%"))

```

```

if research_area and research_area.strip():
    query = query.filter(Paper.research_area.ilike(f"%{research_area.strip()}%"))
if search and search.strip():
    search_filter = f"%{search.strip()}%"
    query = query.filter(
        (Paper.title.ilike(search_filter)) |
        (Paper.tags.ilike(search_filter)) |
        (Paper.author.ilike(search_filter))
    )

```

```

papers = query.order_by(Paper.created_at.desc()).all()
return [
    {
        "id": p.id,
        "title": p.title,
        "author": p.author,
        "year": p.year,
        "topic": p.topic,
        "research_area": p.research_area,
        "tags": p.tags,
        "file_path": p.file_path,
        "reading_status": p.reading_status,
        "read_percentage": p.read_percentage,
        "time_spent_seconds": p.time_spent_seconds,
        "created_at": p.created_at.isoformat() if p.created_at else None
    }
    for p in papers
]

```

```

@router.get("/{paper_id}/file")
def download_paper_file(
    paper_id: int,
    current_user: dict = Depends(get_current_user),
    db: Session = Depends(get_db)
):
    user_id = current_user["user_id"]
    paper = db.query(Paper).filter(Paper.id == paper_id, Paper.user_id == user_id).first()
    if not paper or not paper.file_path:
        raise HTTPException(status_code=404, detail="Paper or file not found")

    if not os.path.exists(paper.file_path):
        raise HTTPException(status_code=404, detail="File missing on disk")

    return FileResponse(paper.file_path, media_type="application/pdf", filename=f"{paper.title}.pdf")

```



File 2: Modify backend/main.py

Open backend/main.py and make only two targeted edits:

Edit 1: Update Router Imports

Locate line 4 in backend/main.py:

Python

CHANGE THIS LINE:

```
from app.routers import auth, admin, dashboard
```

TO THIS:

```
from app.routers import auth, admin, dashboard, papers
```

Edit 2: Register Papers Router

Locate where the routers are included (around lines 17-20):

Python

```
app.include_router(auth.router)
```

```
app.include_router(admin.router)
```

```
app.include_router(dashboard.router)
```

ADD THIS LINE RIGHT AFTER dashboard.router:

```
app.include_router(papers.router)
```



File 3: Modify frontend/app.py

Open frontend/app.py and append these three route functions at the **very end** of the file:

Python

```
# =====
```

```
# Module 1 - Feature 2: Paper Library Routes
```

```
# =====
```

```
@app.route("/papers")
```

```
def papers_library():
```

```
    if "token" not in session:
```

```
        return redirect(url_for("login"))
```

```
    headers = {"Authorization": f"Bearer {session['token']}"}
    params = {}
```

```
    for key in ["topic", "year", "author", "research_area", "search"]:
```

```
        val = request.args.get(key)
```

```
        if val:
```

```
            params[key] = val
```

```
    papers = []
```

```
    try:
```

```
        response = httpx.get(f"{API_BASE_URL}/papers/", headers=headers, params=params)
```

```
        if response.status_code == 200:
```

```

        papers = response.json()
    except Exception as e:
        flash(f"Error fetching papers: {str(e)}", "error")

    return render_template("papers.html", user=session.get("user"), papers=papers,
filters=request.args)

@app.route("/papers/upload", methods=["POST"])
def upload_paper_route():
    if "token" not in session:
        return redirect(url_for("login"))

    headers = {"Authorization": f"Bearer {session['token']}"}

    data = {
        "title": request.form.get("title"),
        "author": request.form.get("author"),
        "year": request.form.get("year") or None,
        "topic": request.form.get("topic"),
        "research_area": request.form.get("research_area"),
        "tags": request.form.get("tags")
    }

    files = None
    if "file" in request.files and request.files["file"].filename != "":
        file_obj = request.files["file"]
        files = {"file": (file_obj.filename, file_obj.stream.read(), file_obj.content_type)}

    try:
        response = httpx.post(f"{API_BASE_URL}/papers/upload", headers=headers, data=data,
files=files)
        if response.status_code == 200:
            flash("Paper uploaded successfully to your library!", "success")
        else:
            err = response.json().get("detail", "Upload failed")
            flash(f"Upload failed: {err}", "error")
    except Exception as e:
        flash(f"Error uploading paper: {str(e)}", "error")

    return redirect(url_for("papers_library"))

@app.route("/papers/<int:paper_id>/file")
def download_paper(paper_id):
    if "token" not in session:

```



```

return redirect(url_for("login"))

headers = {"Authorization": f"Bearer {session['token']}"}
try:
    backend_res = httpx.get(f"{API_BASE_URL}/papers/{paper_id}/file", headers=headers)
    if backend_res.status_code == 200:
        from flask import Response
        return Response(
            backend_res.content,
            mimetype="application/pdf",
            headers={"Content-Disposition": f"inline; filename=paper_{paper_id}.pdf"}
        )
    else:
        flash("PDF file not found or unavailable.", "error")
except Exception as e:
    flash(f"Error: {str(e)}", "error")

return redirect(url_for("papers_library"))

```



File 4: Create Frontend View (New File)

Create a brand new template file at frontend/templates/papers.html.

HTML

```

{% extends "base.html" %}
{% block content %}
<div class="space-y-6 max-w-7xl mx-auto">
  <!-- Header with Modal Toggle -->
  <div class="flex items-center justify-between">
    <div>
      <h1 class="text-3xl font-extrabold text-slate-900">Paper Library</h1>
      <p class="text-slate-600 text-sm mt-1">Upload, search, tag, and organize your research
papers.</p>
    </div>
    <button onclick="document.getElementById('uploadModal').classList.remove('hidden')"
class="px-5 py-2.5 bg-[#5B3DF5] hover:bg-[#4A3AFF] text-white font-bold rounded-xl shadow-sm
transition flex items-center gap-2 text-sm">
      <span>📄</span> Upload Paper
    </button>
  </div>

  <!-- Filter & Search Bar -->
  <div class="bg-white p-5 rounded-2xl border border-slate-200 shadow-sm space-y-4">
    <form method="GET" action="/papers" class="grid grid-cols-1 sm:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-6
gap-3">
      <input type="text" name="search" value="{{ filters.get('search', '') }}" placeholder="Search
title, tag, or author..." class="lg:col-span-2 px-4 py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm
focus:outline-none focus:ring-2 focus:ring-indigo-500">

```

```

        <input type="text" name="topic" value="{{ filters.get('topic', '') }}" placeholder="Topic (e.g.
Vision)" class="px-4 py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2
focus:ring-indigo-500">
        <input type="text" name="author" value="{{ filters.get('author', '') }}" placeholder="Author"
class="px-4 py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2
focus:ring-indigo-500">
        <input type="number" name="year" value="{{ filters.get('year', '') }}" placeholder="Year (e.g.
2025)" class="px-4 py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2
focus:ring-indigo-500">
        <div class="flex gap-2">
            <button type="submit" class="w-full bg-slate-800 text-white font-bold text-sm py-2
rounded-xl hover:bg-slate-900 transition">Filter</button>
            <a href="/papers" class="px-3 py-2 bg-slate-100 text-slate-600 font-bold text-sm
rounded-xl hover:bg-slate-200 flex items-center justify-center">Reset</a>
        </div>
    </form>
</div>

```

```

<!-- Papers Grid -->
<div class="grid grid-cols-1 md:grid-cols-2 lg:grid-cols-3 gap-5">
    {% if papers %}
        {% for paper in papers %}
            <div class="bg-white p-6 rounded-2xl border border-slate-200 shadow-sm hover:shadow-md
transition flex flex-col justify-between">
                <div class="space-y-3">
                    <div class="flex items-center justify-between gap-2">
                        <span class="px-2.5 py-1 bg-indigo-50 text-indigo-700 text-xs font-bold rounded-lg
border border-indigo-100">
                            {{ paper.topic or 'General' }}
                        </span>
                        {% if paper.year %}
                            <span class="text-xs font-semibold text-slate-400">{{ paper.year }}</span>
                        {% endif %}
                    </div>

                    <h3 class="font-bold text-slate-900 text-base leading-snug line-clamp-2" title="{{
paper.title }}">
                        {{ paper.title }}
                    </h3>

                    {% if paper.author %}
                        <p class="text-xs text-slate-500 font-medium">👤 {{ paper.author }}</p>
                    {% endif %}

                    {% if paper.research_area %}
                        <p class="text-xs text-slate-500 font-medium">🔬 Area: {{ paper.research_area }}</p>
                    {% endif %}
                </div>
            </div>
        {% endfor %}
    {% endif %}
</div>

```

```

    {% endif %}

    <!-- Tags List -->
    {% if paper.tags %}
    <div class="flex flex-wrap gap-1.5 pt-1">
        {% for tag in paper.tags.split(',') %}
        <span class="px-2 py-0.5 bg-slate-100 text-slate-600 text-xs rounded-md
font-medium">
            #{{ tag.strip() }}
        </span>
        {% endfor %}
    </div>
    {% endif %}
</div>

    <div class="pt-5 mt-4 border-t border-slate-100 flex items-center justify-between">
        <span class="text-xs font-bold px-2.5 py-1 rounded-full {% if paper.reading_status ==
'Completed' %}bg-emerald-100 text-emerald-800{% elif paper.reading_status == 'Reading'
%}bg-amber-100 text-amber-800{% else %}bg-slate-100 text-slate-600{% endif %}">
            {{ paper.reading_status }}
        </span>

        {% if paper.file_path %}
        <a href="/papers/{{ paper.id }}/file" target="_blank" class="text-xs font-bold
text-indigo-600 hover:underline flex items-center gap-1">
            View PDF ↗
        </a>
        {% else %}
        <span class="text-xs text-slate-400 font-medium">No PDFAttached</span>
        {% endif %}
    </div>
</div>
{% endfor %}
{% else %}
    <div class="col-span-full bg-white p-12 text-center rounded-2xl border border-slate-200
text-slate-500 font-medium space-y-2">
        <p class="text-3xl"><img alt="No papers found icon" data-bbox="345 725 365 740"/></p>
        <p>No papers found matching your criteria.</p>
        <p class="text-xs text-slate-400">Click "Upload Paper" above to add research PDFs to
your library.</p>
    </div>
    {% endif %}
</div>
</div>

<!-- Upload Modal -->

```

```

<div id="uploadModal" class="hidden fixed inset-0 bg-slate-900/50 backdrop-blur-sm flex
items-center justify-center p-4 z-50">
  <div class="bg-white rounded-2xl max-w-lg w-full p-6 shadow-xl border border-slate-200
space-y-5">
    <div class="flex items-center justify-between border-b border-slate-100 pb-3">
      <h2 class="text-lg font-bold text-slate-900">Upload Paper to Library</h2>
      <button onclick="document.getElementById('uploadModal').classList.add('hidden')"
class="text-slate-400 hover:text-slate-600 font-bold">X </button>
    </div>

    <form method="POST" action="/papers/upload" enctype="multipart/form-data"
class="space-y-4">
      <div>
        <label class="block text-xs font-bold text-slate-700 uppercase mb-1">Paper Title *</label>
        <input type="text" name="title" required placeholder="Enter research paper title"
class="w-full px-4 py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2
focus:ring-indigo-500">
      </div>

      <div class="grid grid-cols-2 gap-3">
        <div>
          <label class="block text-xs font-bold text-slate-700 uppercase mb-1">Author(s)</label>
          <input type="text" name="author" placeholder="e.g. Vaswani et al." class="w-full px-4
py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2
focus:ring-indigo-500">
        </div>
        <div>
          <label class="block text-xs font-bold text-slate-700 uppercase mb-1">Year</label>
          <input type="number" name="year" placeholder="2025" class="w-full px-4 py-2 border
border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2 focus:ring-indigo-500">
        </div>
      </div>

      <div class="grid grid-cols-2 gap-3">
        <div>
          <label class="block text-xs font-bold text-slate-700 uppercase mb-1">Topic Tag</label>
          <input type="text" name="topic" placeholder="e.g. Vision, FL, NLP" class="w-full px-4
py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2
focus:ring-indigo-500">
        </div>
        <div>
          <label class="block text-xs font-bold text-slate-700 uppercase mb-1">Research
Area</label>
          <input type="text" name="research_area" placeholder="e.g. Machine Learning"
class="w-full px-4 py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2
focus:ring-indigo-500">
        </div>
      </div>
    </form>
  </div>

```

```

    </div>
</div>

<div>
    <label class="block text-xs font-bold text-slate-700 uppercase mb-1">Custom Tags
(Comma Separated)</label>
    <input type="text" name="tags" placeholder="e.g. Transformer, Attention, Thesis"
class="w-full px-4 py-2 border border-slate-300 rounded-xl text-sm focus:outline-none focus:ring-2
focus:ring-indigo-500">
</div>

<div>
    <label class="block text-xs font-bold text-slate-700 uppercase mb-1">PDF File</label>
    <input type="file" name="file" accept=".pdf" class="w-full text-sm text-slate-500 file:mr-4
file:py-2 file:px-4 file:rounded-xl file:border-0 file:text-xs file:font-bold file:bg-indigo-50
file:text-indigo-700 hover:file:bg-indigo-100">
</div>

<div class="flex justify-end gap-3 pt-3 border-t border-slate-100">
    <button type="button"
onclick="document.getElementById('uploadModal').classList.add('hidden')" class="px-4 py-2 text-sm
font-bold text-slate-600 bg-slate-100 rounded-xl hover:bg-slate-200">Cancel</button>
    <button type="submit" class="px-5 py-2 text-sm font-bold text-white bg-[#5B3DF5]
rounded-xl hover:bg-[#4A3AFF]">Upload Paper</button>
</div>
</form>
</div>
</div>
{% endblock %}

```



Testing & Git Commit

1. Restart your FastAPI backend server:
2. PowerShell

```
uvicorn main:app --reload --port 8000
```
- 3.
- 4.
5. Navigate to <http://127.0.0.1:5000/papers> in your browser.
6. Test uploading a PDF paper and filtering by topic, year, or custom tags!
7. Commit and push cleanly:
8. PowerShell

```
git add .
git commit -m "Module 1 - Feature 2: Paper Upload & Library implementation"
git push origin main
```
- 9.

10.